HIGH-LEVEL DOCUMENTATION

Automation Hub

A web console for running Ansible playbooks on registered servers. It covers operating system patching, configuration changes, compliance reports and on-demand health checks, with role-based access and an audit trail.

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Enterprise automation platform for infrastructure provisioning, OS patching, compliance validation, server lifecycle management, health checks, configuration management, and workflow orchestration.

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Overview

Keeping servers patched, configured and compliant often means running scripts by hand, one server at a time, with little record of who changed what. Automation Hub gives information technology (IT) teams one web console for that work. You register servers in an inventory, keep a library of Ansible playbooks, and run a playbook on one server or many. The console shows each run's output as it happens, keeps the results and reports, and records changes in an audit trail. Operating system (OS) patching playbooks can pause so you can choose which patches to install. Dashboards summarise job outcomes and compliance results, with export to Portable Document Format (PDF) or comma-separated values (CSV). On the Jade Infra SmartOps Portal, Automation Hub is the application tagged Automation, the one that carries out changes on servers. Other portal applications cover areas such as analytics and vulnerability management.

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Who it's for

IO

IT operations engineers

Run patching, configuration and health-check playbooks, then review output and reports.

AA

Automation administrators

Maintain the playbook library, server inventory and user roles, and review playbook change history.

CS

Compliance and security teams

Review compliance results and download the underlying CSV reports.

IM

IT managers

Track success rates, failures and compliance trends, and export them.

PC

Presales and client teams

Show every screen in **Demo Data** mode without touching real servers.

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Key capabilities

Server inventory and lifecycle

- **Register servers**
  Add an existing server with **Add New Server**, including its Secure Shell (SSH) details and tags.
- **Find servers**
  Search by name or address, and filter by operating system.
- **Maintain records**
  Admins edit server details or remove a retired server from the inventory.
- **Prepare servers**
  Run provisioning playbooks on registered servers, for example to install packages or create user accounts.

Configuration management

- **Playbook library**
  Browse playbooks by category, search them, mark favourites and preview them.
- **Upload playbooks**
  Admins add a YAML Ain't Markup Language (YAML) file, or a ZIP project and its main playbook.
- **Edit with history**
  Admins edit playbooks in the browser, and every change keeps the old and new versions.

OS patching

- **Interactive patch selection**
  Compatible patching playbooks pause and open **Select Patches to Install**, so you choose what gets installed.
- **Patch reports**
  View the **Patch Installation Report** with old and new package versions, and download it as CSV.

Workflow orchestration

- **Run on one server**
  Start a playbook on a server and follow its output live.
- **Run across many servers**
  Run one playbook on several servers, in parallel or in sequence, optionally stopping on failure.
- **Control runs**
  Re-run a finished job, or, as an Admin, cancel a running one.

Compliance validation and reporting

- **Compliance results**
  Playbooks that write CSV reports feed compliant and non-compliant counts into the dashboards.
- **Client Dashboard**
  Review network device firmware compliance and operating system patch compliance, with scores and trends.
- **Analytics and export**
  Track success rates, run times and frequent failures, then export them as PDF or CSV.

Health checks and notifications

- **Server health**
  Open a server's details to see current central processing unit (CPU), memory and disk usage.
- **Notifications**
  Get in-app alerts when jobs succeed, fail or finish as a batch, and choose how you are told.

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How it works

You reach Automation Hub through the Portal Gateway, which serves it over Hypertext Transfer Protocol Secure (HTTPS). The Web Console runs in your browser and sends each action to the Automation API (application programming interface). The API checks your sign-in and role, then reads or writes records in the Automation Database.

When you start a run, the API creates a job record and places it on the Job Queue. Job Workers pick up queued jobs and run them in the background. Each worker starts the playbook in the Ansible Engine, which connects over SSH to the target, one of the Managed Servers. The worker saves each line of output and the final status in the database, and the console checks for new output every two seconds.

After a run, the worker collects any CSV reports the playbook produced. Playbooks, run folders and reports are kept in File Storage.

For interactive patching, the playbook tells the API when its patch list is ready. The API prompts your browser over a live connection and writes your choice back to the server.

For health checks, the API reads current usage from the server over SSH.

See the **architecture diagram** for how the components connect.

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Getting started

On the portal home page, find the **Automation Hub** card and select **Launch Demo**. The sign-in page opens in a new tab, with any earlier session cleared.

You sign in with a username and password for an account held by Automation Hub. Request demo access from the portal team. The sign-in page also offers **Create a new account**, which creates a User account.

After **Sign In**, most accounts land on the **Dashboard**, with **Servers**, **Playbooks**, **Total Jobs** and **Success Rate** cards, analytics and **Recent Jobs**. Some accounts land on the **Client Dashboard** instead.

1. Select **Servers**, then **Details** on a server to see its health.
2. Select **Playbooks** and use **Quick Preview** to read a single-file playbook.
3. For sample data, go to **Settings** → **General** and select **Demo Data** under **Data Source**.
4. Select **Run** on a playbook, choose a server under **Select Target Server**, then select **Execute Now**.
5. Follow the output, then select **Jobs** to find the run in **Job History & Logs**.

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Common tasks

01 Add a server to the inventory

1. Select **Servers**, then **Add New Server**.
2. In **Provision New Server**, complete **Hostname**, **IP Address**, **OS Type**, **SSH Port** and **SSH User**.
3. Optionally add **OS Version**, **SSH Key Path** and **Tags**.
4. Select **Add Server**.

02 Run a playbook on several servers

1. Select **Playbooks**, find the playbook, and select **Multi**.
2. In **Execute on Multiple Servers**, tick at least two servers, or select a tag to add its servers.
3. Optionally open **Advanced Configuration** to choose **Parallel** or **Sequential**, set **Maximum Concurrent Servers**, or tick **Stop all executions if one fails**.
4. Select **Execute Batch Job**.
5. Select **Jobs** and expand the batch to follow each server's child job.

03 Patch a server and choose the patches

1. Run a patching playbook that supports interactive selection.
2. When **Select Patches to Install** opens, tick the patches you want, or use **Select All**.
3. Select **Submit Selected** before the countdown ends, or the job is cancelled.
4. When the job finishes, open it from **Jobs** with **Details**, then select **View Patch Report**.
5. Select **Download CSV** to save the report.

04 Review a job and its reports

1. Select **Jobs**, then **Details** on the job.
2. Select **View Console Output** to read the full log.
3. For a successful job, select **View Report** to view or download files the playbook produced.
4. To repeat the run, select **Re-run Job**.

05 Export job analytics

1. On the **Dashboard**, go to **Advanced Analytics & Insights** and choose a range, such as **Last 30 days**.
2. Select **PDF** or **CSV**.

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Roles and permissions

ROLE	WHAT THEY CAN DO
User	View dashboards, servers, playbooks and all jobs. Add servers, run and re-run playbooks, choose patches and download reports. Manage their own notifications and settings.
Admin	Everything a User can do, plus upload, edit and delete playbooks and view their history. Edit and remove servers, cancel jobs, view users and promote a User to Admin.
Super Admin	Everything an Admin can do, plus return an Admin to User and delete accounts. Sees both the **Dashboard** and the **Client Dashboard**.

New accounts from **Create a new account** start as User. All roles see every server, playbook and job.

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Integrations

SYSTEM	WHAT IT'S USED FOR	DIRECTION
Managed servers, over SSH	Running playbooks, reading health figures, and exchanging patch lists and reports	Outbound
Email server (optional)	Sending email alerts; not switched on in the demo	Outbound

There are no cloud, ticketing or corporate directory integrations.

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Security and data

Authentication

Users sign in with a username and password held by Automation Hub. Passwords are stored as one-way hashes. Each request carries a signed session that expires and renews automatically.

Authorization

The Automation API checks your role on every request, and the console hides menu items your role cannot use.

Audit trail

Sign-ins, failed sign-ins, new accounts, and changes to servers, playbooks and jobs are recorded. Admins see before-and-after playbook content in **Playbook Audit Logs**.

Data stored

User accounts, the server inventory, playbooks, job records with full output, reports and notifications. Server records reference SSH keys on the automation host, not the keys themselves.

Encryption in transit

Browser traffic uses HTTPS through the portal gateway, and server connections use SSH.

Data retention

No automatic clean-up is scheduled; records stay until deleted. Notifications leave view after one to three days.

Demo Data mode

Applies to your browser only and sends nothing to managed servers.

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Operations at a glance

Hosting

Runs on a single Linux host shared with other portal applications, behind the portal gateway.

Background processing

Four job worker processes run queued jobs, and each job has a one-hour limit.

Health checks

An internal check confirms the database and job queue respond. Services restart automatically if they stop.

Monitoring and backups

Logs are kept on the host. There is no built-in uptime monitoring or backup.

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Limitations

- It does not create virtual machines or cloud resources. **Provision New Server** registers an existing server.
- There is no scheduler and no chaining of playbooks. Each run is one playbook, started by hand.
- Servers need key-based SSH access from the automation host. Health figures assume Linux and are read only when you open **Details**.
- **Online** and **Offline** show whether a server is active in the inventory, not whether it responds.
- **Notifications** shows sample entries when you have none. The **Client Dashboard** shows sample compliance figures until reports exist. Neither is labelled as sample data.
- **Change Password** under **Settings** → **Security & SSH** and the alert switches in **Settings** do not save yet. Use **Notifications** → **Preferences** for alerts.
- **Invite User** has no action yet. **Debug** and **Upload Folder** are marked as coming soon.
- Email alerts are not switched on in the demo, and **Browser Push** is a stored preference only.

- Console runs have no field for extra variables. A job stops after one hour.
- At review time, uploading new playbooks to the demo failed. Existing playbooks run normally.

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FAQ

Q Does Automation Hub create new servers or cloud resources?

No. It automates servers that already exist and are registered in its inventory.

Q What does a server need before I can automate it?

It must accept key-based SSH connections from the automation host. Then you add it with **Add New Server**.

Q Can we use our own Ansible playbooks?

Yes. An Admin uploads a YAML file or a ZIP project and chooses the main playbook file.

Q Will trying the demo change real servers?

In **Live Data** mode, runs execute on the demo's registered servers. In **Demo Data** mode, nothing reaches a server.

Q How do I get access?

Request demo access from the portal team.

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Glossary

TERM	MEANING
Ansible	Open-source tool that automates tasks on servers over SSH.
Playbook	A file or ZIP project of Ansible tasks.
Job	One playbook run on one server.
Batch job	One playbook run across several servers, with a child job per server.
Inventory	The servers registered in Automation Hub.
Compliance result	Compliant and non-compliant counts from a playbook's report.
Patch	An operating system package update.
Demo Data / Live Data	Bundled sample data, or the demo's real inventory.
Audit trail	Recorded history of sign-ins and changes.
API	Application programming interface.
CPU	Central processing unit.
CSV	Comma-separated values, a plain-text table format.
FAQ	Frequently asked questions.
HTTPS	Hypertext Transfer Protocol Secure, for encrypted web traffic.
IP address	Internet Protocol address of a server.
IT	Information technology.
OS	Operating system.
PDF	Portable Document Format.

TERM	MEANING
SSH	Secure Shell, an encrypted protocol for remote server access.
YAML	YAML Ain't Markup Language, the format playbooks use.
ZIP	A compressed archive file.

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